



**11th Biennial Graduate Conference in Germanic Studies (GCGS 2026)**  
*German-Texas Heritage Society – 507 E. 10th st., Austin, TX, 78701*

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| 7:45 - 8:15   | <b>Arrival at the Conference Venue , Registration &amp; Breakfast</b><br><i>Bagels &amp; Coffee from Rockstar Bagels</i>               |                                                               |
| 8:15 - 8:25   | <b>Opening:</b> <i>Welcome and brief history of the German Free School</i>                                                             | <b>Bradley Barr</b><br><i>President, GAGLS</i>                |
| 8:30 - 9:00   | <i>Translating a Sicilian Requiem: Rosa Balistreri's Forty-Minute Protest Song and the Global Fight Against Femicide</i>               | <b>Amanda Pascali</b><br><i>University of Texas at Austin</i> |
| 9:05 - 9:35   | <i>Elsa Porges-Bernsteins „Dämmerung“: Die Musikszene der Moderne als naturalistischer Schauplatz gesellschaftlicher Kritik</i>        | <b>Lukas Pielenhofer</b><br><i>University of Georgia</i>      |
| 9:40 - 10:10  | <i>Cultural Translatability in Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie's Purple Hibiscus: Navigating Igbo Cultural Elements in German Translation</i> | <b>Joshua Amanam</b><br><i>University of Georgia</i>          |
| 10:10 - 10:30 | <b>Coffee Break</b>                                                                                                                    |                                                               |
| 10:30 - 11:00 | <i>“You Dance on My Living Room Table? ”: Questioning Citizenship and Belonging in German Coming-Out Film Comedies</i>                 | <b>Anne Wooten</b><br><i>University of Texas at Austin</i>    |
| 11:05 - 11:35 | <i>Vergleich der Darstellung des Fremden vor dem historischen Hintergrund des Nationalsozialismus' und des Neuen Deutschen Films</i>   | <b>Helena Hirsch</b><br><i>University of Georgia</i>          |
| 11:35 - 12:35 | <b>Lunch</b><br><i>Tacos from Tacodeli</i>                                                                                             |                                                               |
| 12:35 - 1:05  | <i>Operation Backtalk and the Amerikahäuser as Instruments of Re-Education in Postwar West Germany</i>                                 | <b>Victor Adereti</b>                                         |

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| 1:10 - 1:40 | <i>East German Studies in the Twenty-first Century Classroom</i> | <b>Jared Maul</b><br><i>Michigan State University</i> |
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| 1:45 - 2:15 | <i>Language and Gender Ideologies: Linguistic Politeness</i> | <b>Shallom Ogungbade</b><br><i>Florida State University</i> |
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| 2:15 - 2:35 | <b>Coffee Break</b> |  |
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| 2:35 - 3:05 | <i>Triangular Pedagogies- Mediating Language And Culture For American Learners As A Nigerian Instructor Of The German Language</i> | <b>Veronica Adeloye</b><br><i>Florida State University</i> |
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| 3:10 - 3:40 | <i>Cognate facilitation and processing in English-speaking learners of German</i> | <b>Kaitlin Young</b><br><i>University of Texas at Austin</i> |
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| 3:45 - 4:15 | <i>Using Translation to Bridge Linguistic and Cultural Gaps in Beginner-Level German Language Classrooms</i> | <b>Dr. Nalini Kumaravele</b><br><i>SRM Institute of Science and Technology, India</i> |
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| 4:20 - 4:50 | <i>From Gemini to Confidence: AI Prep Talks for Novice Students of German (AiVE)</i> | <b>Bastian De Monte</b><br><i>The Ohio State University</i> |
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| 5:00 - 6:00 | <b>Keynote:</b> <i>Working Memory and Second Language Acquisition Over the Lifespan: The Quest</i> | <b>Prof. David Birdsong</b><br><i>University of Texas at Austin</i> |
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| 06:00 - 06:15 | Closing remarks | <b>Bradley Barr</b><br><i>President, GAGLS</i> |
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| 6:15 | (Optional) <b>Farewell gathering at Scholz Garden</b><br><i>Food &amp; drinks at participants' own expense</i> |  |
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